

How to test Pluggz

For Lisa and Rachel · about thirty minutes · no technical knowledge needed

Read this first: money is switched on now

Stripe is connected and live, which changes what testing means. **A real payment can now happen.** If you invoice a brand and it is paid, the platform will pay that sale's creator on the next 1st or 15th, with real money. Nothing is a rehearsal any more.

So there is one rule. Do not settle an invoice, and do not press the send button on a payout run, unless you mean it. Everything else on this list is safe to try, and every screen that can move money says so before it does.

If you want to see the money side working without any money moving, ask us and we will walk you through it on a copy.

Before you start

Everything below is on the live site, so anything you record is real. Tell us before you begin and we will clear the test data afterwards.

Ask us for your own sign in rather than sharing one. The site records who approved what, and two people on one login makes that meaningless.

Have a phone to hand as well as a computer. Roughly half of what shoppers do happens on a phone, and it is the half most likely to look wrong.

1. The shopper journey

What someone sees when a creator posts a link.

- Open **pluggzofficial.co.uk** on your phone.
- Tap into a category from the homepage, then tap any product.
- On the product page, tap the button that takes you to the brand.

What should happen: you land on the brand's own website, on that exact product. The address will carry **ref=pluggz** and a **pz=** reference, which is how a sale later gets credited to the right creator.

Worth checking as you go: do the creator names read properly, and does anything look broken on a phone.

2. Does a sale come back

The part that matters commercially. It needs the brand's side switched on first, and we will tell you when a brand is ready.

- Use a Pluggz link to reach the brand, as in step 1.
- Buy something on the brand's site, in the same browser.
- Sign in to Pluggz and open **Record sales**.

What should happen: the order appears within a minute, against the creator whose link you used, with the commission already split between that creator and Pluggz.

Sales are marked **Verified** or **Unverified**. Verified means the brand's own server reported it and the figure cannot have been altered. Unverified means a pixel in the shopper's browser reported it, which is easier to set up but can be blocked by an ad blocker and cannot be proved. Check unverified sales against the brand's own order list before paying commission.

3. What happens to that sale afterwards

You do not have to do any of this. It is here so you can watch it happen and recognise it when it does. Every sale sits at one of four stages, shown on **Payouts**.

Stage	What it means
Pending	Inside the brand's returns window, so it could still be refunded. Nothing is owed to anybody yet
Verified	The window has passed. The sale is now billable
Paid to Pluggz	The brand has paid its invoice, so the creator's share is genuinely ours to pass on
Paid to creator	Sent

Between the second and the third, the platform raises an invoice on its own, overnight, for any brand that owes enough. Between the third and the fourth, it pays the creators on the 1st and the 15th. Neither needs anybody to remember.

Brand invoices shows what has been billed and what has been paid. **Money** shows the whole picture at once: what has come in from brands, what has gone out to creators, and what Pluggz has earned against what has actually reached the company bank.

4. The creator side of getting paid

Worth doing once, so you know what a creator sees when you tell them to set themselves up.

- Sign in as a creator and open **Payouts**.
- Press **Set up payouts**.

What should happen: you are taken to Stripe's own pages, not ours, and asked for your name, address, date of birth and bank details. When you come back, the page says whether Stripe will pay you yet, and if not, exactly what it is still waiting for. You can stop part way through; nothing is set up until Stripe says it is.

Those details are entered on Stripe and held by Stripe. Pluggz never sees them and never stores them. That is the whole reason for using Stripe rather than paying creators by bank transfer: a platform that never sees a bank account cannot leak one.

5. The admin side

Each one should take a minute.

Screen	What to try
Approvals	Approve or decline a creator application
Brands	Add a brand, then copy what it gives you to send them
Products	Add a product by pasting the address of its page
Categories	Add a category, put it in the header, then delete it
Record sales	Upload a sales report and read the preview before recording
Brand invoices	Look at what is ready to bill and what has been paid
Payouts	Look at what is pending, verified and paid
Money	Check the totals agree with what you have just done
Analytics	Check the numbers match what you have just done

- Adding a brand gives you either a tracking script or a key and a secret, depending on what their shop runs on, and that is what you send them.
- Uploading a sales report always shows a preview first, and nothing is written until you press record.
- On **Brand invoices**, raising an invoice and sending it are separate steps, and recording a payment is a third. Raising one is safe. Recording a payment is the one that releases money to creators, so it asks for the bank reference.

6. If something looks wrong

Send us four things. With them we can usually find it in minutes; without them we are guessing.

- What you were doing, in one line
- The address in the browser bar at the time
- What you expected, and what happened instead
- A screenshot, and whether it was phone or computer

Please do not describe it as "it doesn't work" on its own. That is true of several very different faults which have nothing in common, and it costs a day to narrow down.

What we already know about

So you do not spend time reporting these back to us.

- **Twenty listings are hidden** because their brands' websites will not give up a photograph to any automatic read. They are hidden rather than deleted and come straight back the moment we have images. Everything you can see has a picture.
- Three products still have no price, for the same reason.
- Four creator names show as their handle, and every follower count is zero, so that line is hidden rather than showing a nil. We are still waiting on the real names and numbers.

- The creator terms page is placeholder text.
- Creator video is built and connected, but nothing can be uploaded until Cloudflare Stream minutes are purchased.